

TIMELINE BEFORE MARCH 1959

Dynastic Vietnam ■ **Catholics persecuted** ■ French colonialization ■ **The First Indochina War** ■ Battle of Dien Bien Phu ■ **Rise of Ho Chi Minh** ■ Independence won ■ **The Geneva Accords** ■ Operation Passage to Freedom ■ **US support for South Vietnam**

“Our people have **broken the chains** that have **fettered** them for **nearly a century** and have won **independence** for **Vietnam.**”

HO CHI MINH, IN A SPEECH IN BA DINH SQUARE, HANOI, SEPTEMBER 2, 1945